ngrok × WhyUser

ngrok found a missing buyer role and a HIPAA blocker before launch.

The campaign was still the real test.
It just wasn't the first one.

ngrok tested its audience and its outbound emails on a simulated buying committee, fixed what stalled, then kept learning in market.

NEW AUDIENCE

Hours

to a testable buying committee. Manual research took 4 weeks.

CORE ROLES REACHED

3/4→4/4

after one messaging fix brought in Product Managers.

BEFORE SEND

1 blocker

found and fixed: buyers could not verify the HIPAA claim.

WHY NGROK CHOSE WHYUSER

Most tools need weeks of manual data mapping. WhyUser's Ground Reality ingested our site, social sentiment and customer transcripts in minutes, and it keeps learning.

NL

Nichole LaRue
Head of Marketing Operations, ngrok

Nichole also advises WhyUser on go-to-market.

CUSTOMER	ngrok
INDUSTRY	Developer infrastructure
USE CASE	Customer connectivity, taken into HealthTech
TEAM	Marketing Operations, with Sales
WHYUSER USED	Audience Discovery, Landing Page Simulation, Email Copy Simulation
ALSO IN STACK	Clay, Apollo

BEFORE WHYUSER

Getting to a live test took weeks.

Audience research and copy review both happened before any buyer saw the campaign. Finding the audience took 4 weeks. Getting the copy ready took several rounds of review.

01 · FIND THE AUDIENCE

4 weeks

Research, enrich, group roles, find patterns, validate with Sales.

02 · GET THE COPY READY

Multiple reviews

Draft, review, revise, approve. Then buyers finally saw it.

A lot of people reviewed the campaign before a buyer ever did.

Ground Reality gave ngrok a base committee on day one. It starts when the account is created, with no setup, and builds each simulated buyer from real evidence. From there, Audience Discovery turned each new target into a testable committee within hours. How Audience Discovery works

THREE MOMENTS BEFORE LAUNCH

WhyUser surfaced it. ngrok checked it. Then the campaign changed.

Each moment started as a simulated buyer signal. ngrok checked it against Sales, its real inbound or its own proof, and then decided what to change before launch.

WHYUSER SURFACED · NGROK CHECKED · WHAT CHANGED

01 · CUSTOMER CONNECTIVITY

The missing role pointed back to the page.

WHYUSER SURFACED

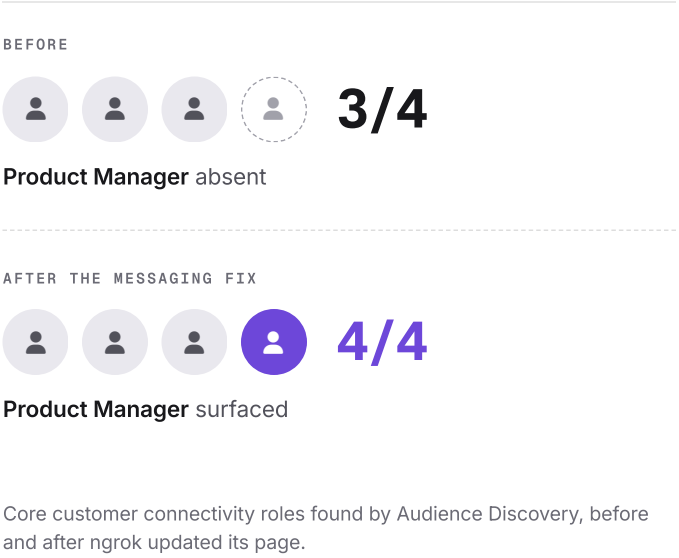
Customer connectivity helps a SaaS company reach private systems inside its customers' networks, with no VPN or firewall changes. ngrok already knew the four core roles for this use case, so its existing landing page became the benchmark. Audience Discovery, which finds the buyer roles a page fits, surfaced three of the four. Product Managers were missing.

NGROK CHECKED

The gap raised a question worth checking: what's missing? Sales had the answer. The customer connectivity page did not speak to Product Managers, so the campaign could miss them.

WHAT CHANGED

ngrok updated the messaging and ran Audience Discovery again. All four core roles surfaced.



Core customer connectivity roles found by Audience Discovery, before and after ngrok updated its page.

02 · HEALTHTECH

A new vertical surfaced a role that matched real inbound.

WHYUSER SURFACED

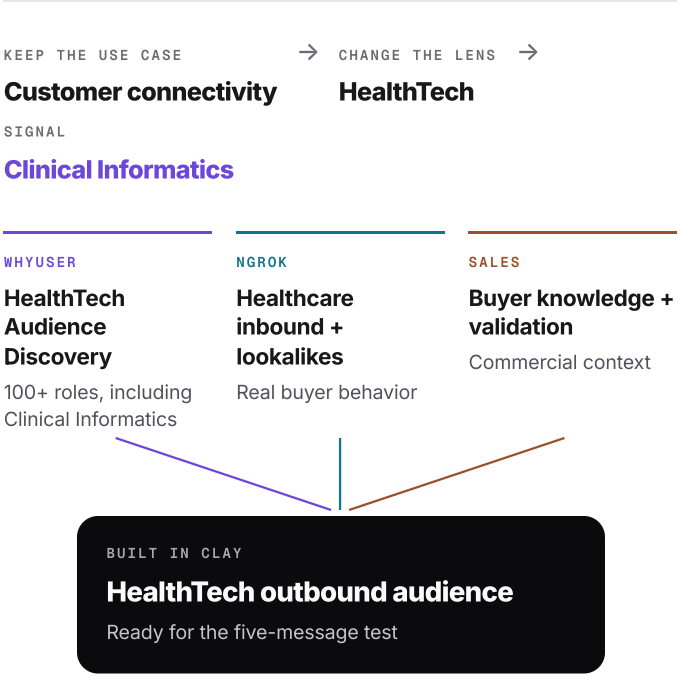
The first run proved what ngrok already knew. Next, ngrok kept the customer connectivity use case, changed the lens to HealthTech and ran Audience Discovery again. It surfaced more than 100 related roles, and Sales validated them. One strong role signal stood out: Clinical Informatics.

NGROK CHECKED

ngrok checked the signal against its real healthcare inbound. It matched. A senior clinical informatics leader was already in that inbound, and had asked about BAAs, the business associate agreements HIPAA requires.

WHAT CHANGED

Discovery became targeting. WhyUser found the roles, ngrok added its inbound and lookalikes, and Sales added buyer knowledge. ngrok built the HealthTech outbound audience in Clay, its list-building tool.



WhyUser found the roles. ngrok added the context.

03 · BEFORE SEND

The buyers wanted to verify the HIPAA claim.

Five people at ngrok, from Marketing Ops, Sales, the CRO and Product Growth, each wrote one outbound email idea. Each one faced the same simulated HealthTech buying committee, built from the new audience, before any email went live.

WHYUSER SURFACED

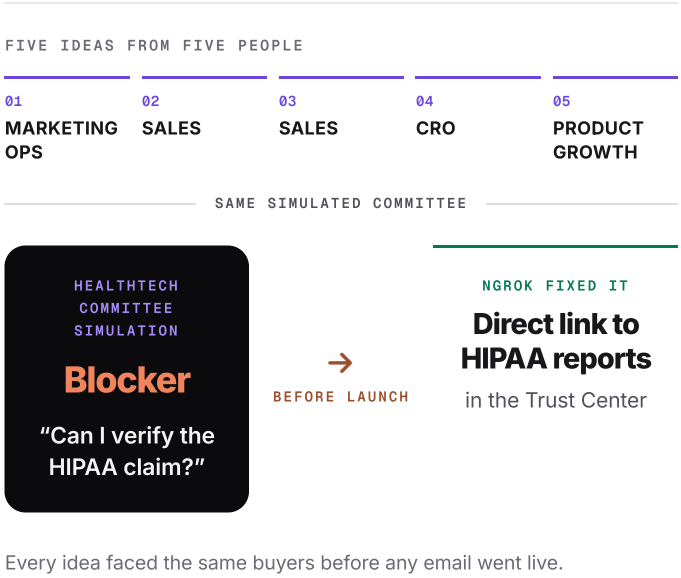
The committee flagged a blocker. Its question: "Can I verify the HIPAA claim?"

NGROK CHECKED

The proof existed. ngrok's HIPAA reports sat in its Trust Center, but the emails did not put them within reach.

WHAT CHANGED

Before launch, ngrok added a direct link to the HIPAA reports in its Trust Center. Buyer feedback became a campaign change.



Every idea faced the same buyers before any email went live.

WHO DID WHAT

WhyUser brought buyer evidence earlier. ngrok decided what to apply.

WhyUser simulated the buying committee and reported what it found. ngrok supplied the context, checked each signal against reality and made every change.

STAGE	WHYUSER DID	NGROK DID
Customer connectivity audience	Surfaced three of four core roles and showed Product Managers were missing.	Confirmed the gap with Sales, updated the page messaging and ran discovery again.
HealthTech audience	Surfaced 100+ related roles, with Clinical Informatics as a strong role signal.	Matched it to real healthcare inbound, added lookalikes and Sales knowledge, and built the audience in Clay.
Outbound emails	Ran five ideas past one simulated HealthTech buying committee and flagged the HIPAA question.	Linked the HIPAA reports in its Trust Center before send.
In market	Ran the reworked emails past the committee again.	Ran the live test in Apollo, kept two ideas and reworked them when the offer changed.

Every WhyUser signal here is simulated. Where this page says a signal “matched,” ngrok compared it with real data it already had. WhyUser does not claim the live results.

IN MARKET

The live test still mattered.

WhyUser changed what ngrok knew before the test began. The market still had the final say.

The five emails went live together in Apollo, ngrok’s sales email tool. While the test was still running, early opens and clicks moved two of the five into the next round.

Then ngrok’s offer changed. ngrok reworked both emails and ran the new versions past the simulated committee again. Next, it applies that feedback and tests again in market.

WhyUser brings buyer evidence earlier. ngrok adds the context and decides what to apply.



ngrok tested before launch, then learned from what happened after.

THAT’S THE LOOP

Marketing has a staging environment now.

DRAFT QUOTE · FOR NICHOLE TO EDIT

> **The campaign was still the real test. It just wasn’t the first one. We went in already knowing the missing role, the healthcare buyer and the HIPAA question.**

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BEFORE YOU SPEND

Stage your next campaign.

Start with Audience Discovery. Bring a campaign you already know the ending to, and see what the committee finds.